

Challenge in 2015, has come up with a highly practical yet fantastic method to make habitable structures on Mars. Using a hot air balloon to harness solar energy and powering a 3D printer, this conceptual project additionally uses an inflatable Living Space module to create completely uncontaminated and pressurised living space on the red planet using the sun and sand. From harnessing energy in the dirt and mud (WildGrid) to making a refreshable Braille reader (Pandabaille; basically, an e-book reader for the visually impaired) to a belt that alerts the wearer whenever their spine posture is poor (Back Belt Yoga), a large number of maker projects all around the world are trying to make this world a better place.



Make magazine's mascot

The maker mentality and why you should care

By now, it is quite evident why the maker movement and the individual maker matters to you, me and all of us. The solutions to some of the world's most persistent problems have been discovered and will be discovered thanks to the maker movement. Just like any other process that needs to affect the entire world, perhaps it will need its own time to become mainstream, but don't let that discourage you from being a maker or supporting yourself. Looking for approval and being a maker are two thoughts quite far away from each other.

A maker is someone with an urge to 'do', to be the change they want to see. Their first love is taking things apart, doing things out of the product which the original designer wouldn't even have imagined. They live by the question of "What can be done with what we have?" A maker, during his work is ready to take risks and accept failures, only to use everything available, the community, the tools, the mindset, to turn around that failure into a glorious, perhaps a bit patchwork-ish, but startling success nonetheless. So go ahead and pick up those tools and start changing the world. 